

ISSUE

No

XIII

AUGUST 25, 2026

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

"IF YOU DON'T LIKE TO READ,
YOU HAVEN'T FOUND THE RIGHT EDITORIALS."



Daily 1 – 4
Latest Editorials



The Hindu,
The Indian Express etc.



Important Vocab
Highlighted in Article



Higher Level
Vocabulary List (C1 & C2)



ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERY DAY



RELEVANT
EDITORIALS

Handpicked Daily



VOCABULARY
LIST
Multiple Synonyms,
Tone & Part of
Speech



SMARTER
PREPARATION

Better
Understanding



STRONGER
RESULTS

Achieve Your Goal

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AUGUST 25, 2026

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“

No. I can survive well enough on my own—if given the proper reading material.

—SARAH J. MAAS



**STAY INFORMED.
STAT AHEAD.
SUCCEED.**



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(The Hindu)

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**RELEVANT
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Invisible actors: On bulk applications, voter name deletion

The Election Commission must urgently curb fraudulent bulk deletions to protect democratic franchise.

17 August 25, 2026 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

The Election Commission of India (ECI)'s Special Intensive **Revision**¹ (SIR) of electoral rolls has seen allegations of bulk filing of applications seeking to delete voters' names from draft lists using Form 7 in Rajasthan, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and, more recently Uttarakhand. Ground reports by The Hindu from Karnataka, Rajasthan and Gujarat noted that these forms were often filed in bulk **fraudulently**⁴ using names of people who were unaware of the filing. In several instances, hundreds of objections were filed under a single person's name. Form 7 is filed to **object to**⁵ an existing name — or to request its deletion — on the electoral rolls for reasons such as death, shifting, or **ineligibility**⁶. The ECI's Booth Level Officer or the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) has to conduct an inquiry on the application and issue a notice to the voter before taking any action. While Booth Level Agents (BLA) of political parties can file up to 10 Form 7s a day, totalling 30, there is no limit on how many forms an individual registered as a voter from the same **constituency**⁷ can submit. To prevent misuse, the ECI has said that if a person files more than five objections, it will trigger a **mandatory**⁸ review by the ERO to ensure the **legitimacy**⁹ of the claims.

The Opposition parties have alleged that the form was being misused through “**systemic**¹⁰ and **coordinated**¹¹ efforts” to delete names of eligible voters and **embolden**¹² the BJP's efforts to wrongfully gain electoral advantage. In the case of Uttarakhand, the Congress has alleged that the manner in which the bulk forms were submitted online pointed to “institutional” access being granted to some in the process. These parties have also sent delegations and submitted representations to the ECI. What is important to note is that in most cases, voters were unaware that applications for deletion of their names had been filed at all, leaving it to workers of political parties active in the **constituency**⁷ to bring it to their notice. According to ECI data, for the third phase of the SIR covering 16 States/three Union Territories there are 3,42,409 BLAs of political parties for an **electorate**¹⁶ of 36,73,87,831 or one BLA for approximately 1,073 voters. These numbers include agents from ruling and Opposition parties. In such a situation, it is **incumbent upon**¹⁷ the ECI to **step in**¹⁸ and protect the voting rights of an individual rather than leave it to the **grassroot**¹⁹ strength of political parties. The ECI should thus take immediate steps to address this concern. **Abnormal**²⁰ patterns should be investigated and the process should be monitored, with a uniform, country-wide Standard Operating Procedure, requiring verification of identity and **constituency**⁷ of the objector and the following of **due process**²¹ before any elector is deleted **pursuant to**²² a Form 7.

Election Commission of India / Special Intensive **Revision**¹ of electoral rolls / Rajasthan / Gujarat / Uttar Pradesh / Uttarakhand / politics / Bharatiya Janata Party / Indian National Congress / political parties / voting

Published: 2026-08-25 · Source: The Hindu

VOCABULARY 101

1. **Revision** (Noun)
update · संशोधन / पुनरीक्षण
2. **Electoral roll** (Noun)
voter list · मतदाता सूची
3. **Allegation** (Noun)
accusation · आरोप
4. **Fraudulently** (Adverb)
dishonestly · धोखे से / कपटपूर्वक
5. **Object to** (Verb)
oppose · आपत्ति उठाना
6. **Ineligibility** (Noun)
unfitness · अयोग्यता
7. **Constituency** (Noun)
voting area · निर्वाचन क्षेत्र
8. **Mandatory** (Adjective)
compulsory · अनिवार्य / बाध्यकारी
9. **Legitimacy** (Noun)
validity · वैधता / औचित्य
10. **Systemic** (Adjective)
widespread · व्यवस्थगत / प्रणालीगत
11. **Coordinated** (Adjective)
organised · समन्वित
12. **Embolden** (Verb)
encourage · हौसला बढ़ाना / बढ़ावा देना
13. **Delegation** (Noun)
envoy group · प्रतिनिधिमंडल
14. **Representation** (Noun)
formal petition · औपचारिक प्रतिवेदन / अर्ज
15. **Bring to notice** (Verb)
inform · संज्ञान में लाना
16. **Electorate** (Noun)
voters · मतदाता वर्ग
17. **Incumbent upon** (Adjective)
binding on · पर अनिवार्य होना / दायित्व होना
18. **Step in** (Verb)
intervene · हस्तक्षेप करना
19. **Grassroot** (Adjective)
community-level · जमीनी स्तर का
20. **Abnormal** (Adjective)
irregular · असामान्य / अनियमित
21. **Due process** (Noun)
legal fairness · उचित कानूनी प्रक्रिया
22. **Pursuant to** (Preposition)
in accordance with · के अनुसार / के अनुपालन में

🔔 Daily Revision

Revise definitions & grammar rules on Page 4.

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EDITORIAL STANCE
Critical
(pointing out flaws)

The author adopts a critical and watchful tone regarding the vulnerability of electoral rolls to mass fraudulent deletions via Form 7. The editorial argues that the Election Commission of India cannot leave vigilance to political party workers and must enforce strict, uniform procedural safeguards. The piece concludes with an urgent call for systemic standard operating procedures to uphold voter rights.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Revision NOUN Neutral	संशोधन / पुनरीक्षण The act of examining something again to alter, update, or correct it.	amendment, modification, re-examination	preservation, stagnation, fixity
Memory Hook: Re + vision = looking at something again to correct or update it.				
2	Allegation NOUN Negative	अरोप A formal claim or assertion that someone has done something illegal or wrong, made without proof.	assertion, charge, accusation	exoneraton, vindication, acquittal
Memory Hook: Sounds like 'alligate' (alligator) — an untamed charge made against someone without instant proof.				
3	Fraudulently ADVERB Negative	धोखे से / कपटपूर्वक In a way that involves deception, cheating, or breach of law for personal or unfair gain.	deceitfully, dishonourably, duplicitously	honestly, lawfully, transparently
Memory Hook: Fraud + ly = acting like a fraud or deceiver.				
4	Mandatory ADJECTIVE Neutral	अनिवार्य / बाध्यकारी Required by law, rule, or official decree; not optional.	obligatory, compulsory, statutory	discretionary, optional, voluntary
Memory Hook: Command → Mandate → Mandatory (ordered by law).				
5	Legitimacy NOUN Positive	वैधता / औचित्य Conformity to the law, established rules, or accepted standards of authenticity.	authenticity, lawfulness, genuineness	illegitimacy, spuriousness, invalidity
Memory Hook: Legal + legitimate = conformity to law and genuine authenticity.				
6	Systemic ADJECTIVE Negative	व्यवस्थागत / प्रणालीगत Relating to or affecting an entire system rather than individual parts.	system-wide, ingrained, institutional	isolated, superficial, localised
Memory Hook: Deeply rooted within the entire *system*, not just an isolated glitch.				
7	Coordinated ADJECTIVE Neutral	समन्वित Planned and executed harmoniously across different people or entities.	synchronised, concerted, harmonised	disorganised, haphazard, uncoordinated
Memory Hook: Co- (together) + ordin- (order) = arranged to function together in order.				
8	Embolden VERB Neutral	हौसला बढ़ाना / बढ़ावा देना To give someone the courage or confidence to do something or to behave boldly.	hearten, fortify, galvanise	dishearten, discourage, daunt
Memory Hook: En + bold = to make someone bold or daring.				
9	Representation NOUN Neutral	औपचारिक प्रतिवेदन / अर्जी A formal statement of reasons, allegations, or grievances made to an authority.	petition, submission, remonstrance	acquiescence, silence
Memory Hook: Re-presenting facts to an authority as a formal appeal or petition.				
10	Grassroot ADJECTIVE Neutral	जमीनी स्तर का Operating at or involving the most basic level of society or ordinary citizens.	ground-level, bottom-up, rank-and-file	top-down, elite, oligarchic
Memory Hook: Originating from the very soil and roots of local ordinary people.				
11	Abnormal ADJECTIVE Negative	असामान्य / अनियमित Deviating noticeably from what is normal, standard, or expected.	anomalous, aberrant, atypical	typical, standard, customary
Memory Hook: Ab (away from) + normal = deviating from the standard pattern.				

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Object to (आपत्ति उठाना): To express disapproval of or challenge something formally.

Incumbent upon (पर अनिवार्य होना / दायित्व होना): Necessary for someone as a duty or responsibility.

Pursuant to (के अनुसार / के अनुपालन में): In accordance with or in execution of a law, rule, or official order.

PHRASAL VERBS

Step in (हस्तक्षेप करना): To become involved in a difficult situation in order to help or resolve it.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Ineligibility (अयोग्यता): The state of not having the necessary qualifications, legal rights, or conditions to be chosen.

Constituency (निर्वाचन क्षेत्र): A geographical area or body of voters represented by an elected legislative official.

Delegation (प्रतिनिधिमंडल): A group of representatives or deputies chosen to represent an organisation or party.

Electorate (मतदाता वर्ग): All the people in a country or area who are entitled to vote in an election.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

Electoral roll (मतदाता सूची): An official register containing the names of all citizens entitled to vote in an election.

Bring to notice (संज्ञान में लाना): To make someone aware of an important fact or situation.

Due process (उचित कानूनी प्रक्रिया): Fair treatment through the normal judicial or administrative procedures according to established law.

STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

Perfect host: On India as host of the 2026 BWF World Championships

India demonstrates exemplary hosting prowess whilst French shuttlers break Asian dominance and home athletes encounter mixed fortunes.

17 August 25, 2026 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

The 2026 BWF World Championships in New Delhi marked the rise of France as an on-court force and of India as a capable host. Alex Lanier's **triumph**¹ in singles, and Thom Gicquel and Delphine Delrue's in mixed doubles, were the first golds in France's history. It was just over three months ago that the European nation finished a worthy **runner-up**² to China in the Thomas Cup, the **de facto**³ World Cup in badminton. The Worlds success has established France as a serious **contender**⁴ in a sport otherwise dominated by Asian countries. In fact, Lanier is just the third non-Asian this century — after Spain's Carolina Marin and Denmark's Viktor Axelsen — to win the singles gold at the World Championships. The 21-year-old did that at a spruced-up Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, which was **in the dock**⁶ earlier in January when pigeons and monkeys intruded into the arena during the India Open. The massive **facelift**⁸ ensured that the **marquee**⁹ event's return to India after 17 years would be long remembered. An Se-Young will also go back with happy memories after reclaiming the women's singles crown from three-time **titlist**¹¹ Akane Yamaguchi. The victory extended the 24-year-old **reigning**¹² Olympic champion's **stellar**¹³ 2026, during which she has won an Uber Cup gold medal, and the individual and team trophies at the Badminton Asia Championships.

For India, the competition was the 12th **straight**¹⁴ edition where it secured at least one medal, with Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly bagging a bronze in women's doubles. The performance is the latest in a series of good outcomes for Indian badminton after an ordinary 2025, where Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty's World Championships doubles bronze was the best result. This year, Lakshya Sen reached the All England Open final, and Ayush Shetty at the Badminton Asia Championships. P.V. Sindhu's victory at the Japan Open Super 750 last month was only her second Tour title in the last four years, and there were also triumphs for Satwiksairaj and Chirag at Singapore Open Super 750, and for Devika Sihag, Tanvi Sharma and Ashmita Chaliha at the Super 300 level. Yet, the feeling is **unmistakable**¹⁶ that India should have done better at a home World Championships, with Lakshya's second-round defeat to the **unheralded**¹⁷ American teenager Garret Tan the most disappointing. There is no questioning the 25-year-old's capability; he is a World Championships bronze medallist, a two-time All England finalist and finished an **agonising**¹⁸ fourth at the Paris 2024 Olympics. But no Indian men's singles player has won an **elite**¹⁹ BWF Super 1000-level title since K. Srikanth in 2017. A swift end to this **drought**²⁰ is essential for the overall health of the sport.

badminton / India / France / Europe / China / Asia / Spain / animal / USA / United Kingdom / Singapore / Japan

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VOCABULARY 101

- Triumph** (Noun)
victory · महान विजय
- Runner-up** (Noun)
second place · उपविजेता
- De facto** (Adjective)
actual · वास्तविक (बिना औपचारिक घोषणा के)
- Contender** (Noun)
competitor · दावेदार / प्रतिद्वंद्वी
- Spruce up** (Verb)
tidy up · सजाना / संवारना
- In the dock** (Phrase)
under scrutiny · कटघरे में / आलोचना के घेरे में
- Intrude into** (Verb)
trespass upon · अनधिकार प्रवेश करना
- Facelift** (Noun)
renovation · कायाकल्प / नवीनीकरण
- Marquee** (Adjective)
headline · प्रमुख / सर्वोत्कृष्ट
- Reclaim** (Verb)
recover · पुनः प्राप्त करना
- Titlist** (Noun)
champion · खिताबधारी / विजेता
- Reigning** (Adjective)
current · वर्तमान (विजेता)
- Stellar** (Adjective)
exceptional · शानदार / उत्कृष्ट
- Straight** (Adjective)
consecutive · लगातार / निरंतर
- Bag** (Verb)
secure · हासिल करना / जीतना
- Unmistakable** (Adjective)
distinct · स्पष्ट / असंदिग्ध
- Unheralded** (Adjective)
unrecognised · अनाम / पूर्वप्रचारित न किया गया
- Agonising** (Adjective)
painful · कष्टदायी / दुखद
- Elite** (Adjective)
top-tier · उत्कृष्ट / शीर्षस्थ
- Drought** (Noun)
dry spell · लंबा सूखा / अभाव का दौर

Daily Revision

Revise definitions & grammar rules on Page 6.

→ Join Ez Editorials

EDITORIAL STANCE
Appreciative yet Evaluative
(praising while critically assessing)

The author adopts an appreciative yet evaluative tone to commend India's successful logistical turnaround as host of the 2026 BWF World Championships and highlights France's historic sporting breakthrough. However, the tone shifts to critical appraisal when examining India's on-court campaign, lamenting the home team's inability to capitalise fully on familiar conditions. The editorial concludes with a pragmatic call for Indian men's badminton to decisively end its prolonged top-tier title drought.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Triumph NOUN Positive	महान विजय A great victory, achievement, or notable success against stiff competition.	conquest, mastery, supremacy	defeat, catastrophe, subjugation
Memory Hook: Sounds like 'try and jump' — when you win a big tournament, you try your best and jump with joy.				
2	Marquee ADJECTIVE Positive	प्रमुख / सर्वोत्कृष्ट Pre-eminent, most important, or commanding the greatest public attention.	flagship, premier, paramount	minor, inconsequential, subsidiary
Memory Hook: The giant brightly-lit marquee above a theatre showcases only the top-billing shows.				
3	Reclaim VERB Positive	पुनः प्राप्त करना To retrieve or win back the possession or control of something previously lost.	regain, recapture, retrieve	forfeit, surrender, relinquish
Memory Hook: Re (again) + claim (demand) = claiming back what once belonged to you.				
4	Reigning ADJECTIVE Positive	वर्तमान (विजेता) Currently holding a title, championship, or supreme office.	incumbent, ruling, prevailing	former, deposed, past
Memory Hook: Like a king 'reigning' on the throne, a reigning champion sits at the top right now.				
5	Stellar ADJECTIVE Positive	शानदार / उत्कृष्ट Exceptionally good, outstanding, or of the highest quality.	exemplary, magnificent, superlative	mediocre, dismal, lacklustre
Memory Hook: Relates to 'stellar' (stars) — performing so brilliantly that it shines like the stars.				
6	Straight ADJECTIVE Neutral	लगातार / निरंतर Unbroken in series; occurring one after another without interruption.	successive, uninterrupted, sequential	intermittent, discontinuous, sporadic
Memory Hook: A straight line has no breaks — an unbroken sequence of events.				
7	Bag VERB Positive	हासिल करना / जीतना To succeed in securing, winning, or obtaining something desirable.	clinch, capture, garner	forfeit, miss out on, lose
Memory Hook: Picture putting the prized trophy directly into your sports bag.				
8	Unmistakable ADJECTIVE Neutral	स्पष्ट / असंदिग्ध Clearly evident and unable to be mistaken for anything else.	unambiguous, unequivocal, palpable	ambiguous, inconspicuous, doubtful
Memory Hook: Un + mistake = impossible to mistake for anything else.				
9	Agonising ADJECTIVE Negative	कष्टदायी / दुःखद Causing immense mental anguish, distress, or acute disappointment.	excruciating, harrowing, tormenting	gratifying, delightful, comforting
Memory Hook: Agony = severe mental or physical pain. Missing an Olympic medal by one spot causes pure agony.				

FIXED PREPOSITIONS
Intrude into (अनधिकार प्रवेश करना): To enter a place, situation, or environment uninvited, disrupting the setting.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS
Runner-up (उपविजेता): A competitor or team that finishes in second place in a contest or championship.
Contender (दवेदार / प्रतिद्वंद्वी): A person, group, or nation that competes with a serious chance of winning a title or prize.
Facelift (कायाकल्प / नवीनीकरण): A comprehensive overhaul or redesign intended to restore or enhance appearance and function.
Titlist (खिताबधारी / विजेता): A competitor who holds a championship title in sports.
Unheralded (अनाम / पूर्वप्रचारित न किया गया): Not previously announced, acknowledged, or celebrated in advance.
Elite (उत्कृष्ट / शीर्षस्थ): Representing the highest class, caliber, or highest tier within a hierarchy.

FOREIGN WORDS
De facto (वास्तविक (बिना औपचारिक घोषणा के)): Existing in fact or reality, whether legally recognised or officially ordained or not.

PHRASAL VERBS
Spruce up (सजाना / संवारना): To make someone or something look clean, neat, smart, and revitalised.

IDIOMS & PHRASES
In the dock (कटघरे में / आलोचना के घेरे में): Being subjected to rigorous public scrutiny, trial, criticism, or blame.
Drought (लंबा सूखा / अभाव का दौर): A prolonged, frustrating period of absence or lack of victories and achievements.

STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

It is wrong to cancel Telangana CM's US visit

Blocking an Opposition leader's foreign visit reflects partisan insecurity and harms federal cooperation.

17 August 25, 2026 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

Instead of heading to Boston as planned on Sunday, Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy **abruptly**¹ flew back to India from London — he was denied permission by the Ministry of External Affairs for the US tour, which led to the cancellation of the **second leg**² of his foreign trip. Undoubtedly, denying permission lay in the MEA's **remit**³. Before it accords political clearance, the visits of chief ministers and other dignitaries are assessed by the ministry for criteria such as the “purpose” and “level” of scheduled meetings. And yet, it is **unseemly**⁶ that the MEA should **weaponise**⁷ the rulebook's **small print**⁸ to **cut short**⁹ CM Reddy's trip. Apparently, the CM's **itinerary**¹⁰ included possible meetings with New York City mayor Zohran Mamdani and US Vice President J D Vance — while the NYC mayor is seen at some levels below the Telangana CM, a meeting with the US Vice President did not fit the trip's stated purpose, which was to attract investment into Telangana, including educational partnerships. This is a narrow-minded approach that does not **behave**¹¹ the external affairs ministry of a country like India, which prides itself on its growing confidence on the world stage, and on building global knowledge hubs like Hyderabad. Moreover, by curtailing an Opposition chief minister's foreign trip, the government looks small and **heavy-handed**¹⁴, sending a **dispiriting**¹⁵ signal to the world — and within the country.

The denial of permission to CM Reddy can be seen as part of a **dismal**¹⁶ pattern of **antagonism**¹⁷, and the near breakdown of dialogue, between government and Opposition at home. This is so even as Reddy, the second CM of a newly carved out state, who began his career in the ABVP, has been seen to tweak the script — in the past, he has struck a note of **pragmatism**¹⁹ and **cordiality**²⁰ **vis-à-vis**²¹ the government of Narendra Modi. In the aftermath, the political **to-and-fro**²² has seen the recycling of tired and opaque spectres and prejudices — the BJP in Telangana has insinuated that the MEA decision was meant to **cut short**⁹ engagement with “anti-India” and/or “anti-BJP” elements, that are out to destabilise “national security”.

After Operation Sindoor in May 2025, the Modi government dispatched seven multi-party delegations, which included prominent leaders of the Opposition, to foreign capitals. They were tasked with making India's case to the world while projecting national unity. The subject, then, was terror, but the message was more generally heartening: That whatever be the political differences within, India's ruling establishment trusted and included the Opposition in its dealings with the world. CM Reddy's abbreviated trip now points to an unfortunate and unflattering **backsliding**²⁵.

VOCABULARY 101

- 1. Abruptly** (Adverb)
suddenly · अचानक / एकाएक
- 2. Second leg** (Noun phrase)
second stage · यात्रा का दूसरा चरण
- 3. Remit** (Noun)
jurisdiction · अधिकार क्षेत्र / कार्यक्षेत्र
- 4. Accord** (Verb)
grant · प्रदान करना / सहमति देना
- 5. Dignitary** (Noun)
VIP · प्रतिष्ठित व्यक्ति / उच्चाधिकारी
- 6. Unseemly** (Adjective)
improper · अनुचित / अशोभनीय
- 7. Weaponise** (Verb)
exploit maliciously · हथियार की तरह इस्तेमाल करना
- 8. Small print** (Noun phrase)
hidden terms · छिपी हुई शर्तें / बारीक नियम
- 9. Cut short** (Phrasal verb)
terminate early · अचानक समाप्त कर देना
- 10. Itinerary** (Noun)
travel plan · यात्रा-कार्यक्रम
- 11. Behove** (Verb)
befit · शोभा देना / उचित होना
- 12. Pride oneself on** (Verb phrase)
take pride in · पर गर्व करना
- 13. Curtail** (Verb)
reduce · घटाना / कटौती करना
- 14. Heavy-handed** (Adjective)
overbearing · कठोर / निरंकुश
- 15. Dispiriting** (Adjective)
discouraging · निराशाजनक / हतोत्साहित करने वाला
- 16. Dismal** (Adjective)
gloomy · निराशाजनक / शोचनीय
- 17. Antagonism** (Noun)
hostility · शत्रुता / विरोध
- 18. Carve out** (Phrasal verb)
create · तराश कर बनाना / अलग करना
- 19. Pragmatism** (Noun)
practicality · व्यावहारिकता
- 20. Cordiality** (Noun)
warmth · सौहार्द / आत्मीयता
- 21. Vis-à-vis** (Preposition)
in relation to · के संबंध में / के मुकाबले
- 22. To-and-fro** (Noun phrase)
back-and-forth · आना-जाना / नोक-झोंक
- 23. Spectre** (Noun)
ghost · साया / भय की आशंका
- 24. Insinuate** (Verb)
hint maliciously · इशारा करना / अप्रत्यक्ष रूप से दोष लगाना
- 25. Backsliding** (Noun)
relapse · पतन / पूर्व की बुरी स्थिति में लौटना

Daily Revision

Revise definitions & grammar rules on Page 8.

➔ Join Ez Editorials

Published: 2026-08-25 · Source: The Indian Express

EDITORIAL STANCE
Critical
(disapproving and fault-finding)

The author adopts a critical tone towards the Union government for revoking diplomatic clearance for the Telangana Chief Minister's US visit. The editorial argues that exploiting procedural technicalities to curb an elected leader's international engagement signals petty partisanship and a breakdown in domestic political trust. In conclusion, the author asserts that such heavy-handed decisions damage India's democratic stature and reverse commendable precedents of cross-party cooperation.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Abruptly ADVERB Negative	अचानक / एकाएक Suddenly and unexpectedly, often with a sense of unpleasantness or haste.	precipitously, unexpectedly, unceremoniously	gradually, progressively, smoothly
Memory Hook: ABRUPT sounds like 'a disrupt' — happening unexpectedly and breaking the normal flow.				
2	Remit NOUN Neutral	अधिकार क्षेत्र / कार्यक्षेत्र The scope of authority, responsibility, or area of jurisdiction assigned to a person or body.	purview, jurisdiction, mandate	powerlessness, proscription, exclusion
Memory Hook: RE + LIMIT = the limits within which an authority is permitted to make decisions.				
3	Accord VERB Positive	प्रदान करना / सहमति देना To grant, give, or bestow official sanction, status, or recognition upon someone.	confer, bestow, vouchsafe	withhold, deny, refuse
Memory Hook: Think of 'According to rules, permission was granted' — to accord is to grant or bestow.				
4	Unseemly ADJECTIVE Negative	अनुचित / अशोभनीय Not proper, appropriate, or suitable according to accepted standards of conduct.	improper, indecorous, unbecoming	seemly, decorous, befitting
Memory Hook: UN + SEEMLY = not seeming right or appropriate for the occasion.				
5	Weaponise VERB Negative	हथियार की तरह इस्तेमाल करना To exploit or adapt a procedure, policy, or rule to gain a hostile political advantage.	instrumentalise, exploit, leverage aggressively	neutralise, disarm, pacify
Memory Hook: Turn any ordinary tool or administrative rule into a 'weapon' to attack an adversary.				
6	Behove VERB Neutral	शोभा देना / उचित होना To be appropriate, morally necessary, or proper for someone to do.	befit, suit, incumbent upon	ill-become, disgrace, misfit
Memory Hook: Sounds like 'be appropriate' — it behoves you to behave well.				
7	Curtail VERB Negative	घटाना / कटौती करना To reduce in extent, duration, or quantity; to impose a restriction upon.	truncate, diminish, retrench	extend, lengthen, expand
Memory Hook: Think of cutting a animal's 'tail' short — to reduce its full length.				
8	Dispiriting ADJECTIVE Negative	निराशाजनक / हतोत्साहित करने वाला Causing a loss of hope, enthusiasm, or confidence.	demoralising, disheartening, daunting	heartening, encouraging, exhilarating
Memory Hook: DIS + SPIRIT = draining the positive spirit or enthusiasm out of someone.				
9	Dismal ADJECTIVE Negative	निराशाजनक / शोचनीय Gloomy, depressing, or characterised by poor quality and lack of hope.	bleak, morose, sombre	bright, cheerful, promising
Memory Hook: Think of 'disaster' + 'mal' (bad) — creating a bleak and cheerless picture.				
10	Antagonism NOUN Negative	शत्रुता / विरोध Active hostility, opposition, or deep-seated mutual animosity.	enmity, animosity, rancour	amity, harmony, concord
Memory Hook: The 'antagonist' in a drama is the enemy who creates constant conflict.				
11	Cordiality NOUN Positive	सौहार्द / आत्मीयता The quality of being warm, polite, and friendly in manner and tone.	geniality, affability, amicability	hostility, aloofness, frostiness
Memory Hook: Root 'cor' means heart (cardiac) — cordial relations come from heartfelt warmth.				
12	Spectre NOUN Negative	साया / भय की आशंका Something widely feared as a possible unpleasant, dangerous, or haunting outcome.	phantom, bogeyman, apparition	reality, actuality, comfort
Memory Hook: Sounds like 'spectator of fear' — an imaginary phantom of dread haunting the mind.				
13	Insinuate VERB Negative	इशारा करना / अप्रत्यक्ष रूप से दोष लगाना To suggest or hint at something bad or improper in an indirect, unpleasant way.	intimate, allude, imply	declare, state openly, articulate
Memory Hook: IN + SIN = hinting that someone has a 'sin' inside them without saying it openly.				
14	Backsliding NOUN Negative	पतन / पूर्व की बुरी स्थिति में लौटना A relapse into bad habits, worse behaviour, or lesser democratic standards after a period of improvement.	regression, retrogression, relapse	advancement, progression, amelioration
Memory Hook: Literally 'sliding back' into inferior, worse behaviour after making progress.				

FIXED PREPOSITIONS
Pride oneself on (पर गर्व करना): To feel deeply satisfied with oneself about a particular skill, status, or achievement.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS
Dignitary (प्रतिष्ठित व्यक्ति / उच्चाधिकारी): A person considered important because of high rank, high office, or government post.
Itinerary (यात्रा-कार्यक्रम): A planned route, schedule, or list of appointments for a journey.
Pragmatism (व्यावहारिकता): An approach that evaluates theories or policies solely in terms of their practical success.

FOREIGN WORDS
Vis-à-vis (के संबंध में / के मुकाबले): In relation to; with regard to; or compared with.

PHRASAL VERBS
Cut short (अचानक समाप्त कर देना): To interrupt or stop something before its scheduled or expected completion.
Carve out (तराश कर बनाना / अलग करना): To establish, separate, or create something through deliberate effort from a larger entity.

IDIOMS & PHRASES
Second leg (यात्रा का दूसरा चरण): The second distinct section or stage of a journey, competition, or multi-part process.
Small print (छिपी हुई शर्तें / बारीक नियम): Technical rules or restrictive conditions often overlooked because they are subtle or buried in bureaucracy.
Heavy-handed (कठोर / निरंकुश): Using excessive force, authority, or clumsy severity without subtlety or tact.
To-and-fro (अना-जाना / नोक-झोंक): Constant movement, exchange of arguments, or dispute back and forth between two sides.

STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

In saying no to Trump, Carney is doing the right thing

Canada sets a firm precedent as middle powers push back against unilateral trade aggression.

17 August 25, 2026 | 2 min read

Daily Editorial Reader

By instructing his negotiators to **walk away from**¹ trade talks with the US — reportedly over Washington's last-minute demands — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has drawn a red line against President Donald Trump's **weaponisation**³ of tariffs. Canada's economy is deeply **integrated with**⁴ that of its superpower neighbour, and Carney's "**dollar-for-dollar**"⁵ **retaliation**⁶ against Trump's 50 per cent tariffs on around \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods will **inevitably**⁷ hurt businesses and workers on both sides of the border. Among other "unacceptable" demands, said PM Carney, Washington seeks to restrict Canada's ability to pursue trade deals with other countries, which would **amount to**⁸ an **erosion**⁹ of Canadian **sovereignty**¹⁰. Elected to power not too long ago on a promise to **stand up to**¹¹ Trump's threats, Carney has done the right thing by rejecting an unequal trade relationship. In doing so, he is also acting on his assessment at Davos seven months ago: The "**rules-based order**"¹², he had said, "is **fading**"¹³.

The Trump tariffs **touch**¹⁴ products from Canadian wine and dairy to furniture, clothing, cement and hockey equipment. Should Carney **proceed with**¹⁵ Canada's **retaliation**⁶ from September 8 onwards, there will be risks, both political and economic, for his country. But the popularity of the "Buy Canadian" campaign — an expression of **economic nationalism**¹⁶ **triggered by**¹⁷ Trump's threats, including making Canada the 51st state of the US — has already shown that many Canadians support their government's challenge to the US president. Carney will now have to convince them that the costs of **confrontation**¹⁸ are worth paying.

For the Canadian PM, the **showdown**¹⁹ with Trump is the clearest test yet of his **thesis**²⁰ that **middle powers**²¹ must **stand up to**¹¹ great powers and unite. Indeed, he has been busy securing deals in Asia and Europe, a **paradigm shift**²² away from Canada's economic **dependence on**²³ the US so far. It is too early to say whether these new partnerships have the substance to **mitigate**²⁴ the pain that a **breakdown in**²⁵ US-Canada relations will cause. But Carney is doing something rather rare in the Trump era: A middle power is saying no to a superpower.

VOCABULARY 101

- 1. Walk away from** (Verb phrase)
abandon · छोड़कर चले जाना / वार्ता से हटना
- 2. Draw a red line** (Idiom)
set a limit · अंतिम सीमा तय करना / लक्ष्मण रेखा खींचना
- 3. Weaponisation** (Noun)
instrumentalisation · हथियारीकरण
- 4. Integrated with** (Adjective + Preposition)
combined with · से एकीकृत / जुड़ा हुआ
- 5. Dollar-for-dollar** (Adjective / Adverb)
strictly reciprocal · समान मूल्य का / पाई-पाई का बदला
- 6. Retaliation** (Noun)
counterattack · प्रतिशोध / जवाबी कार्रवाई
- 7. Inevitably** (Adverb)
unavoidably · अनिवार्य रूप से / अवश्यम्भावी तौर पर
- 8. Amount to** (Verb phrase)
equal · के बराबर होना / समतुल्य होना
- 9. Erosion** (Noun)
deterioration · क्षरण / धीरे-धीरे नष्ट होना
- 10. Sovereignty** (Noun)
autonomy · संप्रभुता
- 11. Stand up to** (Verb phrase)
resist · डटकर मुकाबला करना / विरोध करना
- 12. Rules-based order** (Noun phrase)
international legal framework · नियम-आधारित व्यवस्था
- 13. Fading** (Adjective)
diminishing · घुंघला पड़ता हुआ / क्षीण होता हुआ
- 14. Touch** (Verb)
affect · प्रभावित करना / दायरे में लेना
- 15. Proceed with** (Verb + Preposition)
go ahead with · आगे बढ़ना / जारी रखना
- 16. Economic nationalism** (Noun phrase)
protectionism · आर्थिक राष्ट्रवाद
- 17. Triggered by** (Participle + Preposition)
caused by · के द्वारा प्रेरित / से शुरू हुआ
- 18. Confrontation** (Noun)
clash · टकराव / आमना-सामना
- 19. Showdown** (Noun)
decisive contest · निर्णायक मुकाबला / आर-पार की लड़ाई
- 20. Thesis** (Noun)
proposition · सिद्धांत / प्रतिपाद्य विषय
- 21. Middle powers** (Noun phrase)
secondary states · मध्यम शक्तियाँ
- 22. Paradigm shift** (Noun phrase)
fundamental change · बुनियादी बदलाव / वैचारिक परिवर्तन
- 23. Dependence on** (Noun + Preposition)
reliance on · पर निर्भरता
- 24. Mitigate** (Verb)
lessen · कम करना / शांत करना
- 25. Breakdown in** (Noun + Preposition)
collapse of · में विफलता / टूटन

Daily Revision

Revise definitions & grammar rules on Page 10.

→ Join Ez Editorials

Published: 2026-08-25 · Source: The Indian Express

EDITORIAL STANCE
Commendatory
(approving and supportive)

The author adopts a commendatory tone to endorse Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney's decisive refusal to submit to aggressive US trade demands. While acknowledging the inevitable economic costs and trade disruptions, the editorial argues that defending national sovereignty and diversifying alliances represent a necessary stand for middle powers against great-power coercion.

#	WORD & POS	MEANING (HINDI & ENGLISH)	SYNONYMS (UK)	ANTONYMS (UK)
1	Weaponisation NOUN Negative	हथियारीकरण The act of adapting or exploiting something as a tool of attack, pressure, or coercive leverage. Memory Hook: Turning regular tools or policies into 'weapons' of coercion.	exploitation, mobilisation, instrumentalisation	pacification, disarmament, neutralisation
2	Retaliation NOUN Negative	प्रतिशोध / जवाबी कार्रवाई Deliberate counteraction or reprisal undertaken in response to a harmful act. Memory Hook: Re-TALI-ation: 'Tali' (clapping/hitting) back in response to an attack.	reprisal, counteraction, reciprocation	forgiveness, submission, tolerance
3	Inevitably ADVERB Neutral	अनिवार्य रूप से / अवश्यम्भावी तौर पर In a manner that is completely unavoidable and certain to happen. Memory Hook: In- (not) + Evitable (avoidable) = something you cannot avoid.	inescapably, unavoidably, inexorably	avoidably, preventably, uncertainly
4	Erosion NOUN Negative	क्षरण / धीरे-धीरे नष्ट होना The gradual diminution, weakening, or destruction of an asset, authority, or standard. Memory Hook: Think of soil 'erosion' by water, wearing away solid ground bit by bit.	depletion, degradation, attenuation	strengthening, enhancement, consolidation
5	Fading ADJECTIVE Negative	धुंधला पड़ता हुआ / क्षीण होता हुआ Gradually losing strength, distinctness, vitality, or relevance. Memory Hook: Like a bright photograph losing colour in the sun, something 'fading' loses power and presence.	waning, declining, ebbing	waxing, flourishing, strengthening
6	Touch VERB Neutral	प्रभावित करना / दायरे में लेना To affect, impact, or encompass specific items, sectors, or individuals. Memory Hook: A policy reaches out its hand to 'touch' (influence or tax) various commodities.	impact, affect, encompass	exempt, spare, exclude
7	Confrontation NOUN Negative	टकराव / आमना-सामना A hostile, contentious, or argumentative meeting or situation between opposing parties. Memory Hook: Con- (together) + Front (face) = bringing opposing faces together in conflict.	strife, contention, discord	concord, harmony, reconciliation
8	Showdown NOUN Neutral	निर्णायक मुकाबला / आर-पार की लड़ाई A final, decisive confrontation or contest that settles a long-standing dispute. Memory Hook: In poker, the 'showdown' is when everyone reveals their cards to determine the winner.	climax, culmination, reckoning	compromise, postponement, stalemate
9	Thesis NOUN Neutral	सिद्धांत / प्रतिपाद्य विषय A central proposition, theory, or argument put forward and maintained with reasoning. Memory Hook: A PhD 'thesis' is a core proposition that the researcher defends with evidence.	hypothesis, premise, postulate	fact, axiom, certainty
10	Mitigate VERB Positive	कम करना / शांत करना To make something painful, harmful, or severe less intense or harsh. Memory Hook: Miti-gate sounds like 'Mitti daalna' (put soil over a fire) to reduce its heat and damage.	alleviate, attenuate, palliate	exacerbate, aggravate, intensify

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

Integrated with (से एकीकृत / जुड़ा हुआ): Closely interconnected, blended, or unified with another entity or system.

Proceed with (आगे बढ़ना / जारी रखना): To carry out, continue, or move forward with a planned action or course of events.

Triggered by (के द्वारा प्रेरित / से शुरू हुआ): Set in motion, initiated, or provoked directly by a particular event or action.

Dependence on (पर निर्भरता): The state of relying on or being controlled by someone or something else for survival or stability.

Breakdown in (में विफलता / टूटन): A mechanical failure, disruption, or total collapse in a relationship, system, or discussion.

PHRASAL VERBS

Walk away from (छोड़कर चले जाना / वार्ता से हटना): To abandon or withdraw from a negotiation, agreement, or difficult situation.

Amount to (के बराबर होना / समतुल्य होना): To be equivalent to or have the same overall practical outcome as something.

Stand up to (डटकर मुकाबला करना / विरोध करना): To confront, oppose, or resist someone strong or aggressive with courage.

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Sovereignty (संप्रभुता): The supreme and independent power of a state to govern its own affairs without foreign interference.

Economic nationalism (आर्थिक राष्ट्रवाद): An ideology and policy framework that prioritises domestic economic control, domestic jobs, and tariff barriers over free trade.

Middle powers (मध्यम शक्तियाँ): Sovereign states that possess significant diplomatic and economic influence internationally, though not superpowers.

IDIOMS & PHRASES

Draw a red line (अंतिम सीमा तय करना / लक्ष्मण रेखा खींचना): To set an inviolable limit or boundary beyond which compromise or behaviour will not be accepted.

Dollar-for-dollar (समान मूल्य का / पाई-पाई का बदला): Matching the exact monetary amount or value in response; strictly equivalent and reciprocal.

Rules-based order (नियम-आधारित व्यवस्था): A system of international relations committed to shared agreements, multilateral treaties, and international law.

Paradigm shift (बुनियादी बदलाव / वैचारिक परिवर्तन): A fundamental and transformative change in an approach, policy, or underlying assumptions.

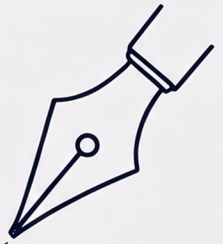
STUDY TIP: Note the connotation and fixed prepositions when solving Cloze Tests, Error Detection, and Sentence Fillers.

**TODAY'S
EDITORIALS**

ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERYDAY



THANK YOU!



“

FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam.

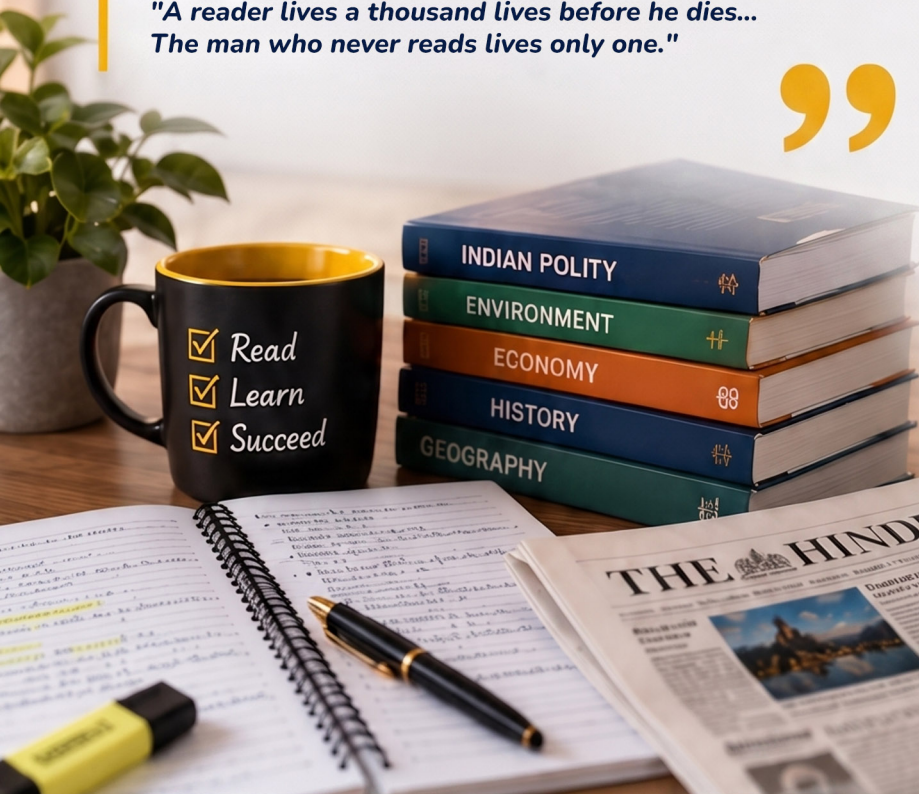


If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

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**"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies...
The man who never reads lives only one."**

”



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